METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

March 2026

MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Raw Material Sourcing Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Raw Material Sourcing Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's),[1] outputs are determined. Raw Material Sourcing is a Key Issue in the Environmental Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on the environmental impacts of the raw materials used in their products and their efforts around supply-chain traceability and certification.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Loss of market access.
- Increased cost of goods sold or additional compliance costs.
- Regulatory penalties, fines, confiscation of product, or loss of access to government contracts.
- Damage to brand value.
- Failure to meet consumer demand for more environmentally sound products.

Raw Material Sourcing Key Issue score

The Raw Material Sourcing Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.

EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.

$MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Raw Material Sourcing Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Raw Material Sourcing Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the

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indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

Component	Sustainability Indicator
Raw Material Sourcing Beef & Dairy Policy score	Commitments towards responsible beef and/or dairy sourcing
	Percentage of beef and/or dairy third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard
	Extent of beef and/or dairy certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria
	Extent of beef and/or dairy traceability to place of origin
	Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of beef and/or dairy production
	Future targets for beef and/or dairy sourcing
Raw Material Sourcing Cotton Policy score	Commitments towards responsible cotton sourcing
	Percentage of cotton third-party certified to an environmental standard
	Extent of cotton traceability to place of origin
	Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of cotton production
	Future targets for cotton sourcing
Raw Material Sourcing Leather Policy score	Commitments towards responsible leather sourcing
	Percentage of leather third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard
	Extent of leather certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria
	Extent of leather traceability to place of origin
	Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of leather production
	Future targets for leather sourcing
Raw Material Sourcing Palm oil Policy score	Commitments towards responsible palm oil sourcing
	Percentage of palm oil third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard
	Extent of palm oil certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria
	Extent of palm oil traceability to place of origin
	Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of palm oil production
	Future targets for palm oil sourcing

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Raw Material Sourcing Sea food Policy score	Commitments towards responsible seafood sourcing
	Percentage of seafood third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard
	Extent of seafood certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria
	Extent of seafood traceability to place of origin
	Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of seafood production
	Future targets for seafood sourcing
Raw Material Sourcing Timber & Paper Policy score	Commitments towards responsible timber and/or paper sourcing
	Percentage of timber or paper third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard
	Extent of timber certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria
	Extent of timber and/or paper traceability to place of origin
	Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of timber and/or paper production
	Future targets for timber and/or paper sourcing

Raw Material Sourcing Management score

The Raw Material Sourcing Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from data points that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Raw Material Sourcing Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

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The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

For indicators related to certification and traceability, we use company-disclosed values where available. Where company disclosures are not sufficiently granular, we extrapolate from company disclosures to derive more granular values.

Raw Material Sourcing Beef & Dairy Policy score

- The Raw Material Sourcing Beef & Dairy Policy score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage the environmental and social impacts of beef and dairy sourcing through policies, certification, traceability and supplier programs. Highest initiatives reflect clear commitments, measurable targets, stringent certification, and full traceability across the supply chain. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.**Commitments towards responsible beef and/or dairy sourcing.**

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Definition: Indicates whether the company has an explicit policy to sustainably source beef and/or dairy (e.g., zero-deforestation beef policy) or whether it belongs to an industry group with such a policy (e.g., the Global Roundtable on Responsible Beef).

- **Percentage of beef and/or dairy third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard.**

Definition: The estimated share of beef and/or dairy externally certified to sustainable standards (e.g., organic certification).

- **Extent of beef and/or dairy certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria.**

Definition: The estimated share of the company's supply of beef and/or dairy externally certified to the most stringent sustainable standards (e.g., Rainforest Alliance).

- **Extent of beef and/or dairy traceability to place of origin.**

Definition: The estimated level of traceability of beef and/or dairy up to the plantation/farm level. Best practice is for all products to be traceable.

- **Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of beef and/or dairy production.**

Definition: The extent of the company's initiatives to develop sustainable practices within its beef and/or dairy supply chain, e.g., sustainable land management program, methane reduction program, implementation of specific sustainable requirements for suppliers and verification of compliance.

- **Future targets for beef and/or dairy sourcing.**

Definition: The extent to which the company has clear, measurable targets for certifying or tracing its sources of beef and/or dairy.

Raw Material Sourcing Cotton Policy score

- The Raw Material Sourcing Cotton Policy score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage the environmental and social impacts of Cotton sourcing through policies, certification, traceability and supplier programs. Highest initiatives reflect clear commitments, measurable targets, stringent certification, and full traceability across the supply chain. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.**Commitments towards responsible cotton sourcing.**

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Definition: Indicates whether the company has an explicit policy to sustainably source cotton or whether it belongs to an industry group with such a policy (e.g., Textile Exchange or Better Cotton Initiative).

- **Percentage of cotton third-party certified to an environmental standard.**

Definition: The estimated share of cotton externally certified to sustainable standards (e.g., Better Cotton Initiative).

- **Extent of cotton traceability to place of origin.**

Definition: The estimated level of traceability of cotton up to the plantation/farm level. Best practice is for all products to be traceable.

- **Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of cotton production.**

Definition: The extent of the company's initiatives to develop sustainable practices within its cotton supply chain, e.g., water and pesticide reduction programs, technical assistance to obtain sustainable certification.

- **Future targets for cotton sourcing.**

Definition: The extent to which the company has clear, measurable targets for certifying or tracing its sources of cotton.

Raw Material Sourcing Leather Policy score

The Raw Material Sourcing Leather Policy score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage the environmental and social impacts of leather sourcing through policies, certification, traceability, and supplier programs. Highest initiatives reflect clear commitments, measurable targets, stringent certification and full traceability across the supply chain. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Commitments towards responsible leather sourcing.**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has an explicit policy to sustainably source leather (e.g., addressing deforestation) or whether it belongs to an industry group with such a policy (e.g., Leather Working Group).

- **Percentage of leather third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard.**

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Definition: The estimated share of leather externally certified to sustainable standards (e.g., Leather Working Group).

- **Extent of leather certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria.**

Definition: The estimated share of the company's supply of leather externally certified to the most stringent sustainable standards (e.g., Recycled).

- **Extent of leather traceability to place of origin.**

Definition: The estimated level of traceability of leather up to the plantation/farm level. Best practice is for all products to be traceable.

- **Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of leather production.**

Definition: The extent of the company's initiatives to develop sustainable practices within its leather supply chain, e.g., technical assistance to obtain sustainable certification, reduction of chemical use in the dyeing and tanning process.

- **Future targets for leather sourcing.**

Definition: The extent to which the company has clear, measurable targets for certifying or tracing its sources of leather.

Raw Material Sourcing Palm Oil Policy score

The Raw Material Sourcing Palm Oil Policy score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage the environmental and social impacts of palm oil sourcing through policies, certification, traceability and supplier programs. Highest initiatives reflect clear commitments, measurable targets, stringent certification, and full traceability across the supply chain. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Commitments towards responsible palm oil sourcing.**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has an explicit policy to sustainably source palm oil (e.g., no deforestation, no peat, no exploitation policy) or whether it belongs to an industry group with such a policy (e.g., the Roundtable on Sustainable Palm Oil).

- **Percentage of palm oil third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard.**

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Definition: The estimated share of palm oil externally certified to sustainable standards (e.g., Roundtable on Sustainable Palm Oil).

- **Extent of palm oil certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria.**

Definition: The estimated share of the company's supply of palm oil externally certified to the most stringent sustainable standards (e.g., Segregated or Identity Preserved Roundtable on Sustainable Palm Oil).

- **Extent of palm oil traceability to place of origin.**

Definition: The estimated level of traceability of palm oil up to the plantation/farm level. Best practice is for all products to be traceable.

- **Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of palm oil production.**

Definition: The extent of the company's initiatives to develop sustainable practices within its palm oil supply chain, e.g., technical assistance to obtain sustainable certification, implementation of specific sustainable requirements for suppliers and verification of compliance.

- **Future targets for palm oil sourcing.**

Definition: The extent to which the company has clear, measurable targets for certifying or tracing its sources of palm oil.

Raw Material Sourcing Seafood Policy score

The Raw Material Sourcing Seafood Policy score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage the environmental and social impacts of seafood sourcing through policies, certification, traceability and supplier programs. Highest initiatives reflect clear commitments, measurable targets, stringent certification, and full traceability across the supply chain. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Commitments towards responsible seafood sourcing.**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has an explicit policy to sustainably source seafood (e.g., banning the sale of endangered species, specifying acceptable fishing methods) or whether it belongs to an industry group with such a policy (e.g., Marine Stewardship Council).

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- **Percentage of seafood third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard.**

Definition: The estimated share of seafood externally certified to sustainable standards (e.g., Global Aquaculture Alliance's Best Aquaculture Practices).

- **Extent of seafood certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria.**

Definition: The estimated share of the company's supply of seafood externally certified to the most stringent sustainable standards (e.g., Marine Stewardship Council, Aquaculture Stewardship Council).

- **Extent of seafood traceability to place of origin.**

Definition: The estimated level of traceability of seafood up to the fishing location/farm level. Best practice is for all products to be traceable.

- **Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of seafood production.**

Definition: The extent of the company's initiatives to develop sustainable practices within its seafood supply chain, e.g., technical assistance to obtain sustainable certification, involvement in Fisheries Improvement Projects.

- **Future targets for seafood sourcing.**

Definition: The extent to which the company has clear, measurable targets for certifying or tracing its sources of seafood.

Raw Material Sourcing Timber Policy score

The Raw Material Sourcing Timber Policy score evaluates the company's initiatives to manage the environmental and social impacts of timber sourcing through policies, certification, traceability, and supplier programs. Highest initiatives reflect clear commitments, measurable targets, stringent certification and full traceability across the supply chain. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Commitments towards responsible timber and/or paper sourcing.**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has an explicit policy to sustainably source timber or whether it belongs to an industry group with such a policy (e.g., Forest Stewardship Council).

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- **Percentage of timber or paper third-party certified to an environmental sustainability standard.**

Definition: The estimated share of timber or paper externally certified to sustainable standards (e.g., Programme for the Endorsement of Forest Certification).

- **Extent of timber certification against the most stringent sustainable criteria.**

Definition: The estimated share of the company's supply of timber externally certified to the most stringent sustainable standards (e.g., Forest Stewardship Council).

- **Extent of timber and/or paper traceability to place of origin.**

Definition: The estimated level of traceability of timber and/or paper up to the plantation or forest level. Best practice is for all products to be traceable.

- **Extent of supply chain initiatives to address impacts of timber and/or paper production.**

Definition: The extent of the company's initiatives to develop sustainable practices within its timber and/or paper supply chain, e.g., technical assistance to obtain sustainable certification, implementation of specific sustainable requirements for suppliers and verification of compliance.

- **Future targets for timber and/or paper sourcing.**

Definition: The extent to which the company has clear, measurable targets for certifying or tracing its sources of timber and/or paper.

Sources: company disclosures; Roundtable on Sustainable Palm Oil; other stakeholder working groups, for example, Rainforest Alliance, Better Cotton, Textile Exchange, Leather Working Group.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Environmental issues in the supply chain controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

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Raw Material Sourcing Exposure score

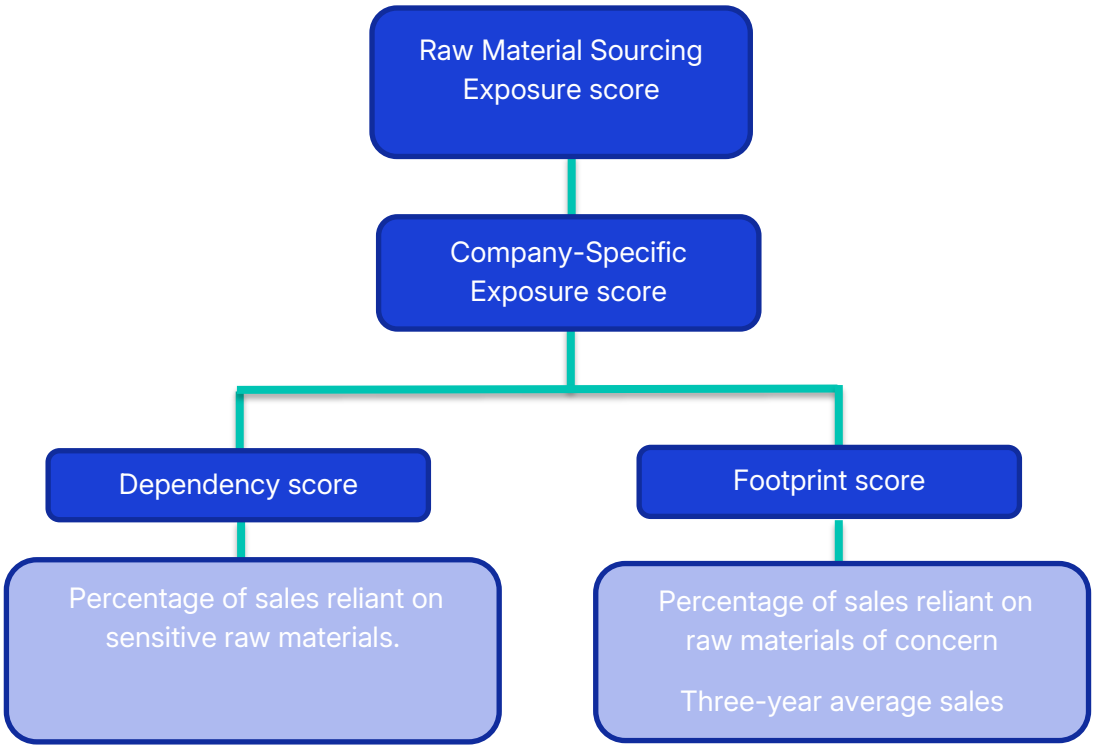
The Raw Material Sourcing Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Company-Specific Exposure Score only. The Company-Specific Exposure Score is scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

$$EXP_{RMS,i} = COM_{RMS,i}$$

Where:

- $EXP_{RMS,i}$ is the Raw Material Sourcing Exposure score of company i.
- $COM_{RMS,i}$ is the Company-Specific Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



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Company-Specific Exposure score

The Company-Specific Exposure score is a simple average of the Dependency score and the Footprint score, sourced by company i.

$$COM_{RMS,i} = \frac{DS_{RMS,i} + FS_{RMS,i}}{2}$$

Where:

$DS_{RMS,i}$ is the Dependency score of company i.

$FS_{RMS,i}$ is the Footprint score of company i.

The Footprint score is calculated as:

$$FS_{RMS,i} = Scale_{0-10}\left\{ESR_{RMS,i} \times 3\ yr\ avgerage\ sales\ _{RMS,i}\right\}$$

Where:

- $ESR_{RMS,i}$ is the Estimated Sales Reliant on all raw materials of concern of company i.
- $3\ yr\ average\ sales\ _{RMS,i}$ is the 3-year sales average of company i.

The Footprint score assesses the company's exposure to environmental risks from the use of raw material of concern, calculated using the percentage of sales reliant on all raw materials of concern, multiplied by the company's three-year sales average, adjusted for private label share where applicable.

The Dependency score is derived as:

$$DS_{RMS,i} = Scale_{0-10}\left\{ESR_{RMS,i}\right\}$$

Where:

- $ESR_{RMS,i}$ is the Estimated Sales Reliant on all raw materials of concern of company i.

The Dependency score assesses the company's dependence on materials of concern based on the percentage of sales reliant on all raw materials of concern.

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Raw Material Sourcing Exposure score:

Refinitiv, MSCI S&C, company disclosures.

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